

Jonathan B. Petkun

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Duke University School of Law

Associate Professor of Law
Courses: Civil Procedure; Access to Justice

2022–present

Yale Law School, Arthur Liman Center for Public Interest Law

Senior Liman Research Affiliate
Senior Liman Research Fellow in Residence

2020–2022

2019–2020

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Ph.D. in Economics

Fields: Public Economics, Labor Economics, Law & Economics, Industrial Organization
Dissertation: “Essays on the Law and Economics of Public Institutions”
Thesis advisors: Jonathan Gruber and Heidi Williams
Fellowships: National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellow (2013–2016)

2013–2020

Yale Law School, J.D.

Colby Townsend Memorial Prize for Best Paper by a Second-Year Student (2018)
Judge Ralph K. Winter, Jr. Prize for Best Paper in Law & Economics (2018)
C. LaRue Munson Prize for Excellence in the Investigation, Preparation, and Presentation
of a Civil, Criminal, or Administrative Case Under Supervision of a Clinical Program (2019)

2016–2019

Swarthmore College, B.A. with High Honors

Harry S. Truman Scholarship; Phi Beta Kappa

2007

RESEARCH & TEACHING INTERESTS

Primary: Public Economics, Law & Economics, Civil Procedure, Federal Courts, Empirical
Legal Studies, Economics of National Security, Access to Justice

ARTICLES & WORKING PAPERS

Laxity, Leniency, and the Liberal Rules of Civil Procedure (with Joseph Schottenfeld) (working paper)

Bonuses, Buyouts, and Worker Sorting in the Public Sector: Evidence from the U.S. Military (with Christina Patterson & William Skimmyhorn), *MANAGEMENT SCIENCE* (forthcoming).

Specialization All Around: Generalist Courts, Specialist Judges (with Jonathan Seymour), 76 *DUKE L.J.* (forthcoming January 2027).

Non-Monetary Incentives & Bureaucratic Performance: Evidence from U.S. Courts, 262 *JOURNAL OF PUBLIC ECONOMICS* (forthcoming October 2026).

Civilian Harm and Military Legitimacy in War: Evidence from the Battle of Mosul (with Benjamin Krick & Mara Revkin), 79 *INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION* 2 (2025): 332–357.

The Judicial Administrative Power (with Joseph Schottenfeld), 93 GEORGE WASHINGTON LAW REVIEW 349 (2025): 349-409.

Reviewed on Jotwell by Emily Bremer ([link](#)).

Do Military Housing Allowances Inflate Local House Prices? (with Paul Goldsmith-Pinkham) (semi-permanent working paper).

POPULAR & SHORTER WORKS

The Progressive Case for American Power: Retrenchment Would Do More Harm Than Good, FOREIGN AFFAIRS (Jun. 2024) ([link](#)).

POLICY REPORTS

ARTHUR LIMAN CENTER FOR PUBLIC INTEREST LAW, TIME-IN-CELL 2019: A SNAPSHOT OF RESTRICTIVE HOUSING BASED ON A NATIONWIDE SURVEY OF U.S. PRISON SYSTEMS (2020) (co-editors Leann Bertsch, Wayne Choinski, Kevin Kempf, John Baldwin, Harold Clark, Bob Lampert, Rick Raemisch, Stephen Sinclair, Dean Williams, Judith Resnik, Anna VanCleave, Alexandra Harrington, Zal Shroff, Brian Highsmith, Atticus Ballesteros, Jaster Francis, Eli Feasley, Molly Petchenik, Jaclyn Willner, and Arianna Zoghi), available at https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=3694548.

FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, & AWARDS

C. LaRue Munson Prize for excellence in the investigation, preparation, and presentation of a civil, criminal, or administrative law case under the supervision of a Yale Law School clinical program	2019
Colby Townsend Memorial Prize for best paper by a second-year student, Yale Law School	2018
Judge Ralph K. Winter, Jr. Prize for best paper in law & economics, Yale Law School	2018
George & Obie Shultz Research Support Grant, MIT	2016
National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship	2013–2016
Phi Beta Kappa (Swarthmore College)	2007
Harry S. Truman Scholarship	2006
Rufus Choate Scholar (Dartmouth College)	2004
Military decorations include Navy & Marine Corps Commendation Medal, Navy & Marine Corps Achievement Medal, and Iraq and Afghanistan Campaign Medals	2007–2011

EXTERNAL GRANTS

Systematic Content Analysis of Litigation Events-Open Knowledge Network (SCALES-OKN) (with Jonathan Anderson & Susan Navarro Smelcer) (\$10,000)	2021
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INVITED PRESENTATIONS

NYU Law & Economics Workshop	Jan. 2025
Washington University in St. Louis Law & Economics Workshop	Nov. 2024
George Mason University Law & Economics Workshop	Sept. 2024
Georgetown University Law & Economics Workshop	Sept. 2024
University of Virginia Law & Economics Workshop	Feb. 2024
University of Michigan Law & Economics Workshop	Nov. 2023
U.S. Air Force Academy Economics Department Workshop	Sept. 2023
UC Berkeley Law & Economics Workshop	Apr. 2023
Notre Dame Law & Economics Workshop	Mar. 2021
FJC Judicial Education Workshop for Judges of the Seventh Circuit, “Judging: Managerial or Not” (with Judith Resnik)	Oct. 2019

TEACHING

Instructor of Record

1L Civil Procedure, Duke University School of Law	Fall 2022–present
Access to Justice (upper-level seminar), Duke University School of Law	Spring 2023–present
Introduction to Legal Analysis & Writing, Yale Law School	Fall 2020

Teaching Assistant

Teaching Assistant to Prof. Judith Resnik, Federal & State Courts in the Federal System, Yale Law School	Spring 2019
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Harold H. Koh, Civil Procedure, Yale Law School	Fall 2018

ACADEMIC CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & WORKSHOPS (SELECTED)

Meeting of the American Law & Economics Association (ALEA) (Spring 2025; Spring 2024; Fall 2021); Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (Fall 2025; Fall 2023; Fall 2018); Civil Procedure Workshop (Spring 2025; Spring 2024); Bolch Institute Judicial Administration/Judicial Process Roundtable (Fall 2024; Fall 2023; Fall 2022); Annual Chicagoland Junior Scholars Conference (Fall 2020); Conference on Data Science & Law (ETH Zürich, Summer 2019); Annual Meeting of the Canadian Law & Economics Association (Fall 2018); Fifth International Conference on Economic Analysis of Litigation (Summer 2018); MIT Public Finance Lunch Seminar (Spring 2018; Spring 2016; Fall 2015)

CLERKSHIPS

Hon. Jeffrey A. Meyer, U.S. District Court for the District of Connecticut, Law Clerk	2021–2022
U.S. Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia Circuit, Law Clerk, hired by the late Judge Williams & reassigned to the chambers of Chief Judge Sri Srinivasan	2020–2021

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Prof. Michael Greenstone, MIT & National Bureau of Economic Research, Pre-Doctoral Research Assistant	2011–2013
United States Marine Corps Reserve, Logistics Officer & Company Commander	2011–2013
United States Marine Corps, Logistics Officer & foreign military advisor, Honorably discharged at the rank of Captain	2007–2011
Center on Budget and Policy Priorities, Federal Fiscal Policy Intern	Summer 2007

BAR ADMISSIONS

New York (2020)

SERVICE & ASSOCIATIONS

Discussant Service: National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) 2024 Summer Institute (Law & Economics program); Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (2025).
Conference Organizing Service: Area Organizer (litigation and empirical civil procedure), American Law & Economics Association (ALEA) Annual Meeting (2025); Area Organizer (litigation and empirical civil procedure), Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (CELS) (2025, 2026).
Referee Service: JOURNAL OF LAW & ECONOMICS; AMERICAN ECONOMIC REVIEW: INSIGHTS; AMERICAN ECONOMIC JOURNAL: APPLIED ECONOMICS; AMERICAN ECONOMIC JOURNAL: MICROECONOMICS; AMERICAN LAW & ECONOMICS REVIEW; INTERNATIONAL REVIEW OF LAW & ECONOMICS; Israel Science Foundation (grant reviewer).